2026

(NEP—2020)

(6th Semester)

ENGLISH (MAJOR)

(Indian Writing in English)

Full Marks : 75

Time : 3 hours

The figures in the margin indicate full marks for the questions.

(SECTION : A—OBJECTIVE)

(*Marks* : 10)

Tick (✓) the correct answer in the brackets provided : 1×10=10

1. The first book ever written in English is

(a) *Recollection of My School Days* ( )

(b) *The Enquirer* ( )

(c) *The Travels of Dean Mahomet* ( )

(d) *Padmini Upakhyan* ( )

2. Many writers in English are

(a) monolingual ( )

(b) illiterate ( )

(c) bilingual ( )

(d) foreign writer ( )

3. "On the Branch of the Casuarina Tree" sat

(a) a young monkey ( )

(b) a black lemur ( )

(c) an eagle ( )

(d) a gray baboon ( )

4. In *In the Zoo*, the poet says that "adjutant storks" come in

(a) one shade ( )

(b) two shades ( )

(c) three shades ( )

(d) four shades ( )

5. The woman in the poem, *A Missing Person* was

(a) sleepy ( )

(b) lazy ( )

(c) drunk ( )

(d) sad ( )

6. The theme of the poem, *Enterprise* is about

(a) tourism ( )

(b) quest in life ( )

(c) friendship ( )

(d) politics ( )

7. In *Harvest*, Ginny avoids physical contact with Om and his family because

(a) she is poor ( )

(b) her parents refuse to meet them ( )

(c) she hates Om's family ( )

(d) she is an imaginative character ( )

8. Om's brother, Jeetu works as a

(a) security guard ( )

(b) delivery boy ( )

(c) salesperson ( )

(d) prostitute ( )

9. Balram wrote to Mr. Wen Jiabao over a period of

(a) five weeks ( )

(b) six days ( )

(c) three months ( )

(d) seven nights ( )

10. Why did Balram murder Mr. Ashok?

(a) Out of personal revenge ( )

(b) To gain freedom and become an entrepreneur ( )

(c) Because of a family dispute ( )

(d) Due to political pressure ( )

(SECTION : B—SHORT ANSWERS)

(*Marks* : 15)

Answer *five* questions, taking at least *one* from each Unit : 3×5=15

UNIT—I

1. List three transformations in Indian Literature due to colonial education.

2. Why do some writers prefer to use the mother tongue over English in writing?

UNIT—II

3. Comment on the title of the poem, *A Missing Person.*

4. How did Ramanujan present the cities of Calcutta and Madras in the poem, *In the Zoo?*

UNIT—III

5. How did Om lose his job?

6. What made Om's mother love him more than his brother Jeetu in the play, *Harvest?*

UNIT—IV

7. What is the significance of the metaphor 'Rooster Coop' in the novel, *The White Tiger*?

8. Why does Balram call himself a 'white tiger'?

(SECTION : C—DESCRIPTIVE)

(*Marks* : 50)

Answer *five* questions, taking at least *one* from each Unit : 10×5=50

UNIT—I

1. Discuss the relationship between language and identity in Indian writing in English.

2. Examine, with relevant examples, how nationalism influenced themes and styles in early Indian English Literature.

UNIT—II

3. The poem, *Our Casuarina Tree* is about sibling love, nostalgia and longing for one's roots. Elaborate.

4. What does the journey symbolize in the poem, *Enterprise*?

UNIT—III

5. Analyze the character of Jaya in *Harvest*.

6. Manjula Padmanabhan's *Harvest* is a play about the moral degradation in humans brought upon by the prospect of securing abundant financial stability. Discuss.

UNIT—IV

7. Trace the rise of Balram from a lowly servant to a successful entrepreneur from the novel, *The White Tiger*.

8. *The White Tiger* is a clever satire on the Indian caste system and the political system. Discuss.

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